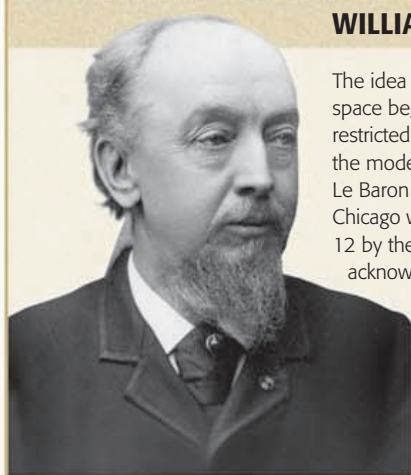


AMERICAN ARCHITECT (1832–1907)

WILLIAM LE BARON JENNEY



The idea of building up instead of out to maximize living space began in the medieval period, when city walls restricted outward expansion. But the man who inspired the modern skyscraper was American architect William Le Baron Jenney, whose Home Insurance Building in Chicago was 10 stories when completed in 1885 and 12 by the time it was demolished in 1931. It is generally acknowledged to be the first skyscraper, not simply because of its height but also because of its method of construction. Jenney's use of steel girders, a skeleton frame, and a "curtain wall" (hung from the frame rather than supporting the building) paved the way for modern skyscrapers.

» The first such town was Letchworth, in Hertfordshire, England, in 1903. Harvey's idea was adopted by the American architect Walter Burley Griffin in his work on Canberra, the capital of Australia.

The spread of urbanization

As cities expanded, so did their infrastructures. Urban transit networks improved, with innovations such as urban trams in 1832 in New York City, underground railroads in London in 1863 (see p.323), and the elevated railroad, in 1867, again in New York City. The improvements in transport led more middle-class workers to move away from downtown areas, giving rise to the concept of suburban living and the commuter belt—residential areas on the periphery of a city. This in turn led to expansion of the suburbs, which in some cases meant cities absorbing entire towns and villages into their urban sprawl and filling the spaces that once

separated them with new housing and facilities. In some countries this resulted in legislation limiting the extent of expansion and the creation of "green belts" around cities.

City living was not simply about the buildings in which people lived and worked; it also affected their habits and ways of thinking. City-dwellers had greater anonymity than rural villagers, which gave them greater license in many aspects of their lives. This included sexual practices—infidelity and prostitution were higher in the cities—and religion: atheism was markedly higher in urban areas, which led to an increase in church-building and to the establishment of institutions like the Salvation Army, to bring people back to religion.

Leisure and pleasure

By the end of the 19th century, two new social phenomena had emerged: the leisure industry and consumerism. These arose from a combination of

"Hell is a city much like London..."

PERCY BYSSHE SHELLEY, ENGLISH POET, 1819



▽ Glasgow, Scotland

Glasgow's population increased twentyfold from 1780 to 1900, by which time it was known as "the Second City of the Empire." This picture, from 1860, shows the cramped conditions resulting from a population boom.



▽ Moscow, Russia

This wide, shop-lined street, photographed in 1890, is typical of the ambitious building program that was undertaken in Moscow in the late 19th century.



◁ Piccadilly Circus, London

Despite being built in the early 19th century, by the time of this photograph, taken in 1910, the roads of London's Piccadilly Circus were having to accommodate early motor cars (see pp.344–45), as well as more traditional horse and carts.



◁ Manchester, England

By the end of the 19th century, Manchester was a thriving industrial city. Market Street (shown here) is one of the city's main thoroughfares.